

UNSA - MUN Conference - Rules of procedure

General Provisions

The Rules of Procedure include those procedures destined to be adopted to regulate the conduct of in-person sessions.

1.Language

1.1 English is the official language of UNSA's conference committee sessions. Other languages are not permitted for inclusivity purposes.

2.Dress Code

2.1 All delegates are required to adhere to a formal business attire dress code.

2.2 Traditional attire is permitted as long as they are respectful of the country's culture.

2.3 Character portrayal and/or cultural appropriation are not allowed.

3.Attendance

3.1 Attending the committee sessions is mandatory for all participants of the conference.

3.2 If a delegate is unable to attend a committee session for justified reasons, they must communicate this in advance to the Chairs/tutors.

4.Personal Conduct

4.1 All participants shall maintain diplomatic decorum throughout the conference.

4.2 UNSA's pillars include diversity and inclusion. Participants are expected to treat each other respectfully. No form of discrimination shall be tolerated and will be considered a severe violation of this RoP.

4.3 A delegate who repeatedly does not abide by these rules may be suspended from the committee session by the Chairs.

5.Use of technology and AI

5.1 Usage of electronic devices is only allowed for specific purposes during sessions, which will be at the discretion of the chairs. It is therefore recommended to bring all materials printed.

5.2 Usage of AI during the simulation and abuse of AI in writing speeches and position papers is strictly prohibited.

5.3 Plagiarism without proper references will lead to disciplinary measures by the Staff/Chairs.



6.The Chairs

6.1. They will be responsible for guiding the committee sessions and the procedural matters to guarantee a proper flow of the debate.

6.2. Their responsibilities include: Declaring the opening and closing of sessions, suspending formal debates, opening the floor for points and motions, composing the Speakers List, and granting speaking rights.

7.Staff

7.1. They will be responsible for aiding the delegates throughout the conference. Participants can refer to ushers to ask for clarifications, pass notes to other delegates and/or the chair, and express other needs.

7.2. They will handle other logistics of the conference; they are identifiable by their credentials.

7.3. Purple Point: This member of our staff is dedicated to ensuring delegates' wellbeing, including handling breaches of Article 5 (of these rules of procedure).

Delegate guidelines

1.1. All participants must carry their conference identification throughout the event.

1.2. Delegates representing a United Nations Member State shall speak on its behalf in the third person. They have voting rights over the issue at stake within their respective committee.

1.3. Delegates are expected to be on time.

1.4. During the **roll call**, delegates have to specify their status as “Present” or “Present and Voting” (if Present and Voting, one cannot abstain from voting); if a delegate arrives late, they should communicate their status through a parliamentary note to the Chair.

1.5. A committee session may be opened if at least $\frac{1}{3}$ of the delegates are present.



1.6. For the purposes of this conference, formal debates will be referred to as moderated by the chairs, and informal debates as unmoderated caucuses.

2.General Speakers' List (GSL)

2.1. At the beginning of the debate, the **General Speakers' List (GSL)**, the default debating mode, will open. Chairs will call for the first delegates to be added to the List for opening statements in no specific order. This will continue to be done for the rest of the speeches throughout the debate.

2.2 Those who have not been added can request inclusion in it by raising their placard vertically, otherwise for motions, raise it horizontally.

3.Yields

3.1. A delegate only yields time after delivering a speech from the General Speakers' List.

3.2. A delegate who has been granted the right to speak and has not exhausted their allotted speaking time shall yield their remaining time in one of the following ways:

3.2.1. To another delegate, who shall either:

- a. Accept the yield and deliver a speech for the remaining time;
- b. Or reject the yield, in which case the time is automatically yielded back to the Chairs.

3.2.2. To questions: the Chairs will then ask for and select delegates who wish to pose a question to the speaker. In this instance:

- a. Questions must concern the substance of the speaker's speech. Follow-up questions shall only be allowed at the discretion of the Chairs.
- b. Comments or statements will be deemed to be out of order.
- c. The speaking time will only be deducted when the yielding delegate is replying.

3.2.3. Back to the Chairs: The formal debate will continue.

4.Opening Statements

4.1. At the beginning of the debate on each topic, time will be allocated to the General Speaker's List for some of the delegates present to deliver opening statements on the position of their country of representation, for a maximum of one (1) minute thirty (30) seconds.



5.Right of Reply

5.1. A delegate, whose personal or national integrity has been infringed by another delegate may, at the end of the latter's speech, request a Right of Reply. This may only be granted during the formal debate.

5.2. The delegate has 30 seconds to speak, and a response to a Right of Reply is not allowed.

Points and Motions

1.Raising a Motion or a Point

1.1. Motions shall be raised only once the Chairs have stated the floor is open. The floor is open when the committee is in formal debate, no points or motions are being processed, and no delegate is exercising their right to speak.

1.2. In order to raise a motion, delegates must raise their placards horizontally. Once they have been acknowledged by the Chairs, they may state their motion.

1.3 To be adopted, motions require a Simple Majority (50% + 1) unless explicitly stated otherwise.

1.4. In order to raise a point, the delegate must raise their hand and wait to be acknowledged by the chairs.

2.Point of Personal Privilege

2.1. This point aims to remove a personal discomfort affecting the Delegate's performance in the committee; for example, not being able to hear properly.

2.2. If the point of personal privilege is due to the delegate's inability to hear a speech, the delegate may raise the provided red card.

3.Point of Order

3.1. This point aims to address an improper procedure according to the Rules of Procedure.

4.Point of Information

4.1. This point can be utilised to clarify doubts about RoPs or the topic at hand.

5.Motion for Moderated Caucus

5.1. This motion shall be raised for delegates to discuss a specific aspect of the agenda. To do so, the delegate proposing it must state: Topic, time per speaker, and total time.

5.2. This motion must be voted upon. If it passes, the delegate who proposed the motion shall have the opportunity to speak first or last.

5.3. The Chairs have the discretion to determine when this motion may be out of order.



6.Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

6.1. This motion allows delegates to debate freely and gather to discuss specific aspects of the agenda or to work on committee documents.

6.2. The Delegate who proposed it must state its total duration. This motion requires voting.

6.3. The Chairs shall have the discretion to determine when this motion may be out of order.

7.Motion to Extend the Previous Caucus

7.1. A Delegate may propose an extension of the previous Moderated or Unmoderated Caucus right after it has come to an end. The extension may not consist of more than half of the original length of the caucus.

7.2. It must be supported by a Simple Majority to be passed. It is under the Chair's discretion to rule this motion out of order. This decision is not subject to appeal.

8.Motion for a Tour de Table

8.1. This motion allows every State represented in the committee to be heard on a particular aspect of the topic. It may be introduced at any point when the floor is open.

8.2. The Chairs may rule the motion out of order. This decision is not subject to appeal.

8.3. To be adopted, the Motion will require a Simple Majority. If approved, every delegate shall take the floor in alphabetical order for a maximum of one (1) minute, expressing their opinion on the issue at stake.

9.Motion for a Consultation of the Whole

9.1. This motion allows the committee to engage in discussion in no particular pre-established order of delegates.

9.2. This motion requires a Simple Majority vote to pass.

9.3. The proposal of this motion only has to specify a total time, as there will be no individual speaking time in this motion.

9.4. The delegate who introduces this motion shall be the first speaker. They do not have a minimum or maximum of minutes to make their speech, and hence could use the entire time of the motion to address the committee if they wish to.

9.5. The delegate who introduces this motion shall have the freedom to decide how the Consultation of the Whole will be moderated. There are three ways in which the consultation of the whole can be moderated:

a. By the Chairs: After a speaker finishes speaking, the Chair will recognise the next speaker(s).



b. By the Delegate who proposed the motion: After a speaker finishes speaking, the delegate who introduced the motion will recognize the speakers.

c. Successive Order (Ping-Pong style): Once a speaker has finished speaking, they are the ones to recognise the next speaker. This shall go on until the time of the motion has elapsed.

10.Motion to Appeal the Decision of the Chairs

10.1. The Chairs' decisions on procedural matters shall be appealed unless explicitly stated in this RoP.

10.2. An appeal must be made immediately after the Chairs' ruling. The Delegate will be given 45 seconds to explain the reasoning behind the appeal, and the Chairs will briefly speak in favour of the decision.

10.3. The appeal will then be voted upon. To pass, it requires a qualified majority.

11.Motion for Suspension of the Meeting

11.1. This motion aims to interrupt the committee session temporarily. It may only be in order when this suspension is called for by the conference's schedule.

11.2. The Chairs may deem the motion to be out of order. This decision cannot be appealed.

12.Motion for Adjournment of the Meeting

12.1. Its purpose is to close the meeting on the last day of the conference, deferring the meetings until the following year.

12.2. The Chairs may rule it out of order when proposed before the time scheduled. This is not subject to appeals.

13.Motion to Modify the Speakers' Time

13.1. The Delegate proposing the motion must specify the length of time they wish to change to.

13.2. The Chairs may decide it is not in order. This shall not be appealed.



Documents

1. Working Paper

- 1.1. A delegate may distribute a document to the committee as a “Working Paper”, for which no particular criteria are required, nor sponsors or signatories.
- 1.2. A Working Paper must receive the Chair’s approval before it is introduced as a “Draft Resolution” to ensure it addresses the committee’s main issues.
- 1.3. Working Papers will be numbered according to the chronological order of their submission.
- 1.4. Working Papers may be shared through collaborative platforms such as Google Docs to enable the participation of different delegations in the drafting of potential clauses.

2. Draft Resolution

- 2.1. A Draft Resolution shall be introduced when it meets the form and substance requirements expected by the Chairs, and the minimum number of Sponsors and Signatories needed. The meeting of the requirements will be overseen by the Chairs.
- 2.2. The Motion to introduce a Draft Resolution requires a simple majority (50% + 1).
- 2.3. After the Draft Resolution has been introduced, it will be distributed electronically to the committee and will be read by one of its sponsors.
- 2.4. After the presentation of a Draft Resolution, the Chairs will open the floor for questions. Delegates will raise their placards to ask Draft Resolution sponsors for doubts/clarifications.
- 2.5. If other delegates wish to introduce their Draft Resolution(s), doing so will be in order after the process described has been finalized for the previous one. Amendments will be entertained after all draft resolutions have been presented.

3. Sponsors

- 3.1. Sponsors are the main writers and supporters of a Draft Resolution.
- 3.2. Unless otherwise stated, a minimum of two (2) sponsors are required for a Draft Resolution to be introduced. The maximum number of sponsors will be four (4).



4. Signatories

4.1. Signatories are delegations wishing to discuss the Draft Resolution, which are not bound to vote in favour of it.

4.2. Unless stated otherwise, a minimum of four(4) signatories are required for a Draft Resolution to be introduced. There is no maximum number of them.

5. Amendments

5.1. An approved Draft Resolution may be modified through amendments. Amendments are written modifications of the Draft Resolution that aim to add, remove, or revise one or several operative clauses.

5.2. Amendments will be introduced after all the Draft Resolutions have undergone a question session.

5.3. An amendment may be:

a. Friendly: Amendments that have the support of all the Draft Resolution's sponsors. They will be incorporated into the resolution without a vote.

b. Unfriendly: Amendments that are not accepted by the sponsors. They will be debated by the committee and voted upon.

5.4. The delegate proposing an unfriendly amendment will be granted a total of one (1) minute to explain their position in favour of the amendment. Then, the sponsors of the Draft Resolution will respond with a 1-minute speech against the amendment. After this, 1 minute can be allotted for questions between them and the rest of the committee.

5.5. The unfriendly amendment will be subjected to a vote, requiring a Simple Majority to pass.

6. Resolution

6.1. Only once the amendments have been added or rejected for all the Draft Resolutions on the floor, the Motion to Vote upon Draft Resolution X will be in order.

6.2. The Resolution is an official document adopted by the committee.

6.3. A Draft Resolution requires $\frac{2}{3}$ of votes to pass. Once passed, the voting procedure will end.



Voting Procedure

1.General Rules Concerning Voting Procedure

1.1. Each Delegate shall have one (1) vote.

2.Required Majorities

2.1. A Simple Majority requires that more than half of the committee is in favour of the subject of the vote (50%+1).

2.2 A Qualified Majority requires that $\frac{2}{3}$ of the committee is in favour of the subject of the vote.

3.Request for Roll Call Vote

3.1. A delegate may request a Roll Call Vote. This consists of calling upon the delegates to vote by taking the floor one by one and voicing their vote in English alphabetical order.

5.2. Delegates may vote in favour, against, temporarily abstain (to see the opinion of the room and vote in a next round based on that) or abstain.

4.Motion to Vote Clause by Clause

4.1. A Motion to Vote Clause by Clause asks for voting on each operative clause of a Resolution individually.

4.2. This motion requires a Simple Majority.

4.3. Entertaining a Roll Call Vote and a Vote Clause by Clause may be out of order because of time restraints.

5.Motion to Divide the Question

5.1. This motion may be raised by a delegate wishing to vote on particular clauses separately from the rest of the Draft Resolution, for instance, if they have been included through unfriendly amendments.

5.2. This motion requires a Simple Majority.

5.3. If the separated clauses receive the required majority, they shall remain part of the Draft Resolution. If they fail to do so, they shall be eliminated from the Draft Resolution.

